

 Note!

What's actually happening when you extend (or contract) a selection is that the computer is keeping track of the original insertion point and adjusting only the end of the selection. It's as if one end of the selection is anchored to the insertion point and you can move the other end around the document as if the selection were a rubber band. Remember, the IIGs recognizes backward drags, so it's possible to move the end of the selection before the insertion point and switch a forward selection to a backward selection!

 Note!

It's also possible to select more text than will fit on the screen (in programs like word processors) by shift-clicking. Click the insertion point, then scroll the window to find the end of the desired selection and shift-click there. (See next section for more information on scrolling.)

Double-click to select an entire word. Triple-click to select an entire line (or the entire field if it's a line-edit field). If you double-click and hold the second click, dragging selects entire words; if you triple-click and hold the third click, dragging selects entire lines.

Selection can also be performed from the keyboard. Use the left and right arrow keys to move the insertion point to the beginning of your selection. Now, hold down the Shift key and press the right arrow key until the desired selection is highlighted. (You can also start at the end of the selection and use Shift with the left-arrow key to "drag backward" with the keyboard.) And, of course, you can also use the ⌘ and Option keys with Shift to extend the selection to the beginning or end of a line or to the previous or next word.

Finally, when you use Tab (or ⌘-Tab) to move from one field to another in a dialog, the field you tab into is automatically selected. (When a dialog first appears, the first field is selected.)

 Shortcut

A quick way to select the entire contents of a line-edit field is to press ⌘ and Left Arrow (to move the insertion point to the beginning of the line), then press ⌘, Shift, and Right Arrow (to extend the selection to the end of the line).

Editing Text

Once you've selected the text you wish to edit, editing can begin. The simplest operation is deletion—to obliterate the text, just press the Delete key (or select "Clear" from the Edit menu, or press the Clear key on the IIGs's numeric keypad).

If you want to replace the selected text with new text, simply begin typing. The selected text will be deleted and the new text you type will be inserted. (Since the entire contents of a line-edit field are selected when you Tab into it, you can just begin typing if you want to replace the default text with new information. You'll get used to filling in and accepting dialogs this way—type something, Tab, type something, Tab, Tab, type something, Return.)